DANIAL SALMAN

Owen Graduate School of Management, 401 21st Avenue South, Nashville, TN 37203
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ACADEMIC POSITION

Postdoctoral Scholar in Finance *2026–present*
Owen Graduate School of Management, Vanderbilt University

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Business Administration (Finance) *2026*
Foster School of Business, University of Washington

B.A. and **M.A.** in Economics (Dual Degree Program) *2017*
Boston University

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Household Finance, Labor and Finance, Innovation, and Venture Capital

WORKING PAPERS

End of the Road? Autonomous Vehicles and Displacement Risk [SSRN]

New technologies have renewed concerns about job displacement. In this paper, I link workers' subjective displacement expectations to their direct and social exposure to a disruptive technology: autonomous vehicles (AVs). I find that commercial driver licensing and employment in truck driving fall disproportionately in more AV-exposed areas. The remaining drivers extend their work hours and reduce participation in mortgage markets relative to less-exposed, neighboring drivers. Changes in household spending on alcohol and tobacco products are consistent with heightened automation-induced anxiety. The results indicate that perceived displacement risk affects households' labor supply, credit behavior, and health, all of which could inform welfare assessments and policy responses to automation.

**NBER SI 2026 Digital Economics and Artificial Intelligence, NBER Economics of Transportation Spring 2026, Colorado Finance Summit 2025*

**Featured in the Financial Times*

Relief Beliefs: Effects of Anticipated Student Loan Forgiveness (with Xuan Xie) [SSRN]

We evaluate the consumption response to President Biden's August 2022 student loan forgiveness announcement, which promised $10,000 to $20,000 in debt relief to approximately 42 million borrowers. Retail stores located in counties with a 1 percentage point higher share of eligible borrowers experienced a persistent 0.1% increase in weekly sales following the announcement. This response was absent in counties with high shares of financially delinquent households. Sales subsequently declined in more-exposed counties when the Supreme Court blocked the plan. Together with widespread debt relief applications, the spending responses show that beliefs about ultimately unrealized debt relief affected households' anticipatory behavior.

**NBER Economics of Education Spring 2026, 10th Anniversary SAFE Household Finance Workshop*

**FMA 2025 Annual Meeting Best Paper Award (semifinalist)*

WORK IN PROGRESS

Who Benefits from Venture Capital? (with Victor Lyonnet and Léa Stern)

PUBLICATIONS

Pre-doctoral:

Institutional and Political Determinants of Statutory Tax Rates: Empirical Evidence from Sub-Saharan Africa (with Sanjeev Gupta, Carlos Mulas-Granados, Jianhong Liu and Kelsey Ross)
Journal of African Development, 2021 [Article]

The Future of Central America: Challenges for Sustainable Development
Inter-American Development Bank, 2019 [Book]

INVITED CONFERENCES, SEMINARS, AND WORKSHOPS

2026: NBER SI Digital Economics and Artificial Intelligence, NBER Economics of Transportation, NBER Economics of Education, SAFE Household Finance Workshop, American Economic Association, American Finance Association[‡], Junior Academics Research Seminars in Finance, University of Texas at Dallas, Vanderbilt University

2025: Colorado Finance Summit, ABFR Doctoral Research Symposium, Coast-to-Coast Doctoral Workshop, Southern Finance Association[*], Financial Management Association, Society of Labor Economists, Wharton Innovation Doctoral Symposium, Inter-Finance PhD Seminar[*], NBER Entrepreneurship Research Boot Camp

2024: Western Economic Association International, Financial Management Association[†]

2023: Wharton Summer School on Structural Estimation in Corporate Finance, Finance Theory Group Summer School

[*] denotes presentations by co-authors, [†] denotes discussions, and [‡] denotes posters

REFEREE

Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Co-Organizer of the UW Finance PhD Alumni Conference *2026*

Chair of the "Governance & Firm Management" session at FMA *2024*

AWARDS

Edna Benson Fellowship *2023*

Foster PhD Program Fellowship *2022*

George and Pearl Corkery Scholarship *2019*

Student Research Award *2016*

Presidential Scholarship *2013–2016*

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Washington *2019–2026*
Teaching Assistant

- Corporate Finance (Undergraduate, Full-time MBA, Hybrid MBA)
- Advanced Corporate Finance (Full-time MBA)
- International Finance (Full-time MBA, Executive MBA)
- Game Theory (Full-time MBA)
- Introductory Macroeconomics (Undergraduate)
- Introductory Microeconomics (Undergraduate)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of Washington *2021–2026*
Research Associate

Center for Global Development *2017–2019*
Research Assistant

Inter-American Development Bank *2017*
Consultant

Boston University *2016*
Research Assistant

United Nations Secretariat *2016*
Intern

REFERENCES

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MISCELLANEOUS

Citizenship	United States
Data Clearance	Census Bureau Special Sworn Status
Languages	English, French, Urdu/Hindi, Spanish
Volunteer	Court Appointed Special Advocate (CASA)